vdemdata

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NAMESPACE	version 2.0	6 years ago
README.md	v16 release	7 months ago
vdemdata.Rproj	upload	7 years ago
vdemdata_16.0.tar.gz	v16 release	7 months ago

About

An R package to load, explore and work with the most recent V-Dem (Varieties of Democracy) dataset.

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README

An R package to load, explore and work with the most recent V-Dem (Varieties of Democracy) and V-Party datasets.

V-Dem: Global Standards, Local Knowledge

Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) conceptualizes and measures democracy. We provide a multidimensional and disaggregated dataset that reflects the complexity of the concept of democracy as a system of rule that goes beyond the simple presence of elections. The V-Dem project distinguishes between five high-level principles of democracy: electoral, liberal, participatory, deliberative, and egalitarian, and collects data to measure these principles.

We are a team of over 50 social scientists on six continents. We work with more than 5,000 country experts. Read more about the work we do here.

The vdemdata R package

This package contains the most recent V-Dem (Country-Year: V-Dem Full+Others) and V-Party datasets and provides some additional functions. Other versions of the V-Dem dataset can be downloaded from our website.

Basics:

- `vdem` : Load the V-Dem dataset (for non-R users, please access the V-Dem dataset here)
- `vparty` : Load the V-Party dataset (for non-R users, please access the V-Party dataset here)
- `var_info` : Print to the console basic information on a specific variable as given in the codebook of the V-Dem dataset
- `find_var` : Search variables via keywords in the V-Dem dataset
- `fill_vars` : Fill election-specific variables in the V-Dem dataset

Graphics:

- `plot_indicator` : Plot V-Dem indicators for exploratory data analysis.

Installation

```
# Install the development version of the vdemdata package
# (the package is an ongoing project,
# keep checking for updates)

# First, you need to have the devtools package installed
install.packages("devtools")
# now, install the vdemdata package directly from GitHub
devtools::install_github("vdeminstitute/vdemdata")

# NOTE: make sure you have an updated R version and
# - since the package is a development version -
# an updated version of rlang, xcode (Mac), rtools (Windows), r-base-dev (Linux)
# installed. If you have troubles with the installation
# write to contact@v-dem.net at the V-Dem Institute.
```